

Strategic Sales Pipeline and Performance Management: An Educational Guide to the Sales Tracker

This educational document provides a comprehensive breakdown of the "Get.1a.Sales Tracker" model. By systematically recording and analyzing sales activities, pipeline velocity, and referral networks, this spreadsheet-based tracking system creates a transparent environment that benefits both the advisor and the business owner.

For the purposes of this guide, each primary dashboard or worksheet within the tracker is treated as a core "template."

Section 1: Detailed Breakdown of Core Templates (Tracker Sheets)

1. Stats to Date Dashboard

- **Core Benefits:** Provides a high-level, macro view of the entire firm's sales performance and lead generation channels. It tracks exact conversion rates across different approach styles (e.g., Direct Contact vs. Quiz Link Sent) and prospect sources (e.g., Referrals vs. Social Media).
- **How it helps the Advisor:** It reveals which sales styles (Campaign vs. Total Needs) are yielding the highest average fee values (\$67 vs \$0 in the current sample) and where to focus their energy for the best return on time.
- **How it helps the Business Owner:** It offers an objective measurement of marketing ROI. The owner can instantly see that 75% of agreeable prospects are new opportunities, and exactly how many meetings are required to generate a proposal.
- **Suitable for:** Firm owners, managing partners, and sales directors who need a macro-level overview of firm-wide conversion metrics.

2. Team Report

- **Core Benefits:** Breaks down the firm-wide statistics into individual performance metrics for team members (e.g., Michael, Sam, Doris, and Duncan). It evaluates prospects approached, meetings secured, proposals sent, and the total value of work secured per person.
- **How it helps the Advisor:** It provides clear, undeniable metrics regarding their personal performance, allowing them to track their average proposal value and win rate (e.g., Doris converting at 100% vs. Duncan at 34.6%).
- **How it helps the Business Owner:** It helps identify training opportunities. If one advisor is excellent at securing meetings but fails to close jobs, the owner can intervene with targeted sales coaching.
- **Suitable for:** One-on-one performance reviews, team accountability meetings, and identifying top performers.

3. Sales Activity Log

- **Core Benefits:** Acts as a lightweight CRM (Customer Relationship Management) system. It records the micro-level details of every prospect (e.g., Joe's Plumbing Supplies, Bill's Truck Shop), tracking contact info, current sales stage, proposal values, and next moves.
- **How it helps the Advisor:** Ensures no prospect falls through the cracks. It tracks follow-up dates and calculates "Work Days Elapsed," giving the advisor a clear indication of when a deal has stalled and requires intervention.
- **How it helps the Business Owner:** Provides a concrete visualization of the active pipeline and pending revenue. It categorizes leads by their exact status (Active, Await Research, Completed, Dead, On Hold) for accurate cash flow forecasting.
- **Suitable for:** Daily use by all client-facing advisors to log activities, updates, and upcoming follow-ups.

4. COI (Centres of Influence) Development

- **Core Benefits:** Systematizes the development of referral networks. It records the relationship status with key external professionals like bankers, lawyers, and insurance brokers (e.g., tracking Bobby Brianson at BNZ or Billy Bobby at Smiths Law).
- **How it helps the Advisor:** Gives the advisor a structured method to nurture referrers, moving them through stages from "Could We" to "How Would We" to "Will We" test/review. It ensures the advisor focuses on COIs who actually provide valuable referrals.
- **How it helps the Business Owner:** It quantifies the value of external relationships. By tracking total referrals, conversions, and fee value generated per COI (e.g., \$23,000 from Billy Bobby), the business can measure the ROI of networking and partnership efforts.
- **Suitable for:** Senior partners, business development managers, and advisors tasked with building organic growth through strategic alliances.

5. Tracker Configuration (Lists & Calcs)

- **Core Benefits:** Operates as the engine room of the tracker. "Lists" contains the standardized dropdown menus (Relationship Type, Approach Styles, Meeting Themes, Total Needs Stages) ensuring data integrity. "Calcs" handles the background statistical math (Standard Deviations, Variance, Averages).
- **How it helps the Advisor:** Dropdown menus make daily data entry fast, uniform, and less prone to typing errors.
- **How it helps the Business Owner:** Ensures that when reports are generated, the data is perfectly categorized, making the final statistical variance and averages highly reliable for decision-making.
- **Suitable for:** The system administrator or operations manager responsible for setting up and maintaining internal tracking tools.

Section 2: Step-by-Step Practical Application

Here is a practical method for setting up and using the tracker in a daily sales environment:

- **Step 1: System Configuration (Lists Tab).** Before deploying the tracker to the team, navigate to the Lists tab. Populate the exact team members (Partners and Staff Support), standard meeting themes (e.g., Lite Funda' Sales, Formal Risk Mgt), and approach styles your firm uses.
- **Step 2: Prospect Entry (Sales Activity Log).** Whenever an advisor makes an approach, they must immediately log a new row in the Sales Activity log. They should fill out the prospect name, business name, lead staff member, prospect source, and approach style used.
- **Step 3: Managing the Pipeline (Sales Activity Log).** As the relationship progresses, the advisor updates the "Prospect Status" (Active, Dead, Completed) and logs whether a meeting was secured. If a proposal is requested, the value is entered into the "Proposal Value" column.
- **Step 4: Cultivating Referrals (COI Development).** After a networking event or coffee meeting with a professional like a commercial lender or lawyer, the advisor adds their details to the COI Development tab. They update the relationship progress column (1 for yes, 0 for no) as trust builds, eventually tracking any closed fee value that originated from this relationship.
- **Step 5: Management Review (Stats & Team Report).** At the end of each month, the business owner or sales manager reviews the "Stats to Date" and "Team Report" tabs. They assess the total value of work proposed versus work secured to evaluate win rates and adjust the firm's overarching sales strategy accordingly.

Section 3: Common Q&A

1. How does the tracker differentiate between small-scale sales and complex consulting engagements?

The tracker distinctly categorizes the "Sales Style" into either "Campaign" or "Total Needs". Campaigns generally involve predefined meeting themes like a "Planning Review" or "Lite Funda' Sales", whereas Total Needs tracks deeper stages like "Scope", "Analyse Data", and "Implementation".

2. What is the most effective "Approach Style" according to the tracker?

The tracker actively monitors conversion rates for various methods such as Direct Contact, Pre-Approach Sequences, Gifts, and Quiz Links Sent. Over time, the "Stats to Date" tab calculates

exactly which of these approach styles yields the highest percentage of agreeable prospects, allowing the firm to double down on what works.

3. How do we monitor a prospect who isn't ready to buy yet?

In the Sales Activity log, the "Prospect Status" column should be updated to "On Hold" or "Await Research". This keeps them in the system for future follow-up without falsely inflating the immediate, active pipeline revenue expectations.

4. What is the purpose of tracking "Work Days Elapsed"?

In the Sales Activity tab, calculating "Work Days Elapsed" allows the advisor and manager to see how long a deal has been sitting in the pipeline. High numbers (e.g., 119 or 145 days) indicate that a deal is stalling and requires immediate follow-up or needs to be marked as "Dead" to keep the pipeline realistic.

5. How do we evaluate whether a Centre of Influence (COI) is worth our time?

The COI Development tab directly ties a specific "Fee Value" to the referrals provided by that relationship. If a COI remains at the early "Could We" relationship stage for months without ever progressing to a "Test/Review" or generating fee value, the advisor knows to redirect their networking efforts elsewhere.

6. Why is it important to track "New Prospects" vs. "Existing Clients"? Tracking the "Relationship Type" (Existing Client vs. New Prospect) in the Stats to Date dashboard allows the business to see if its growth is purely organic (upselling current clients) or if its external marketing/lead generation strategies are successfully bringing in fresh blood to the business.

Section 4: Source Summary Table

Template Name	Core Focus & Contents
Stats to Date	A macro dashboard tracking firm-wide approach volumes, quiz completions, meeting conversions, and average fee values, categorized by Campaign vs. Total Needs styles.
Team Report	Breaks down sales performance by individual team members, calculating their specific number of proposals sent, engagements won, total value secured, and average win rate percentage.
Sales Activity Log	A row-by-row CRM database tracking individual prospect details, lead sources, meeting dates, exact proposal values, work days elapsed, and specific follow-up notes.
COI Development	A networking tracker mapping relationships with external professionals (bankers, lawyers, etc.), their progression stages, the number of referrals given, and the specific monetary value generated.
Lists	The configuration data source containing dropdown validations for relationship types, approach styles, prospect sources, meeting themes, and staff names.
Calcs	Background spreadsheet calculations determining averages, variances, and standard deviations for more complex statistical reporting.

Section 5: If-Then Logic Table

Logic Branch	IF (Condition / Trigger)	THEN (Action / Next Step)	Additional Context / Notes
Approach Methodology	IF the prospect is generated via a "Cold Target" or "Social Media" source...	THEN start the process by using the "Quiz Link Sent" approach style to qualify their interest.	Quizzes act as a low-friction barrier; if completed favourably, the prospect is much warmer for a follow-up call.
Sales Pathway Selection	IF the initial engagement is categorized under the "Lite Funda' Sales" or "Planning Review" theme...	THEN log the sale under the "Campaign" sales style track.	Campaigns are generally faster to close and require less bespoke discovery.
Complex Engagement Tracking	IF the prospect requires a "Full Discovery" or "Issue Response"...	THEN utilize the "Total Needs" tracker and update their progress through "Scope", "Analyse Data", and "Presentation" stages.	Total needs selling is bespoke and requires careful staging to ensure no steps are skipped.

Pipeline Stagnation	IF the "Work Days Elapsed" in the Sales Activity log exceeds 90 days without a job being secured...	THEN change the Prospect Status to "On Hold" or "Dead" and move on.	Keeping stalled prospects active artificially inflates the pipeline projection.
COI Relationship Progression	IF a new meeting is held with a "Commercial Lender" or "Farm Consultant" and they agree to explore a mutual alliance...	THEN change the relationship progress indicator from "Could We" (1) to "How Would We" (1) in the COI tab.	Relationships must be systematically nurtured through these trust stages before referrals can be expected.
Resource Allocation	IF the "Team Report" shows an advisor has an exceptionally low "Secured Conversion %" despite a high number of approaches...	THEN assign a senior partner as "Support Staff (Buddy)" on their next Active prospect.	Tracking allows owners to spot weaknesses and implement peer mentoring to save active deals.